

This House Would Ban the Use of AI in Schools

Definitions:

- AI: Large language models (LLMs), such as ChatGPT and Gemini, that are not specifically monitored or designed by the school for student use.
- Schools: Primary and secondary education.
- Ban: An outright ban with no exceptions. Anything that falls under our definition of AI cannot be used by students.

Government

Argument 1: AI reduces students' development of critical thinking

1. AI can complete schoolwork quickly and effectively.
 - AI can generate answers, essays, explanations and solutions very quickly.
 - This creates a strong incentive for students to use AI instead of completing work themselves.
2. Therefore, students are more likely to rely on AI rather than doing work independently.
 - Instead of struggling through a problem, researching it or working out an answer themselves, students can simply ask AI.
 - This means they get less practice doing these things independently.
3. Students develop skills through practice and experience.
 - Critical thinking is not just something students learn by being told what it is.
 - Students need to repeatedly:
 - analyse information
 - research
 - solve problems
 - form arguments
 - make decisions
 - evaluate whether information is reliable.
4. Therefore, greater reliance on AI means less opportunity to develop these skills.

So what?

- These skills are important beyond school.
- Students will eventually need to make decisions and solve problems without an AI doing the thinking for them.
- If students become accustomed to outsourcing difficult thinking to AI, they may have less independent experience to draw upon.

Argument 2: Teachers lose the ability to accurately assess students' knowledge

1. Teachers need students to complete work themselves in order to understand their abilities.
2. If students use AI to produce their work, the work may not accurately represent the student's own knowledge or skills.
3. Therefore, teachers have less reliable information about what a student actually understands.
4. This makes it harder for teachers to identify gaps in a student's knowledge.

So what?

Teachers need to know what students understand so they can:

- identify weaknesses
- provide additional support
- adjust teaching
- give appropriate feedback
- recognise when a student is struggling.

Opposition

Argument 1: AI provides students with help when teachers aren't available

1. Students will sometimes struggle with homework or a task outside school.
2. A teacher may not always be available to answer their questions.
 - It could be outside school hours.
 - The student may not be able to contact their teacher.
 - The teacher may not have enough time to provide individual explanations to every student.
3. AI can provide an immediate explanation.
 - A student can ask AI to explain a concept.
 - They can ask for the explanation to be simplified or presented differently.
 - This does not necessarily mean asking AI to complete the task.
4. Therefore, banning AI removes a potentially useful source of support for students.

So what?

- Students who cannot access additional help are particularly affected.
- AI can give students a way to continue learning independently rather than simply giving up when they don't understand something.

Response to Government

The Government's argument assumes that students can always get the support they need from teachers or schools.

But schools have limited resources.

- Teachers cannot provide unlimited one-to-one support.
- Students do not have equal access to additional tutoring or help outside school.

Therefore: AI can fill some of the gaps between what a student needs and what a teacher is able to provide.

Argument 2: AI can personalise learning

1. Students do not all learn at the same pace or in the same way.
 - Some students understand a concept immediately.
 - Others need more explanation.
 - Some benefit from examples or practice questions.

2. Traditional classroom teaching cannot always be individually tailored to every student.
 - One teacher may have many students.
 - They have limited time and resources.
 - It is difficult to provide every student with completely personalised explanations.

3. AI can adapt its explanations to the individual student.

For example, a student can ask it to:

- explain something more simply
- give another example
- explain it using an analogy
- create practice questions
- explain where they went wrong.

4. Therefore, AI can provide additional personalised practice and explanations.

So what?

- Students can spend more time working on the areas they personally struggle with.
- This can make learning more accessible and allow students to work at their own pace.

Argument 3: AI can help students develop useful research skills

1. Students need to learn how to find and evaluate information.

2. AI can be used as part of the research process.

- Students can ask questions.
- They can use AI to identify areas they need to investigate further.
- They can compare explanations and sources.

3. Students can learn to assess whether AI's answer is reliable.

4. This can encourage students to think critically about information rather than simply accepting the first answer they find.

So what?

Research and information-evaluation skills are important because students will constantly encounter information online.

How to Develop Any Argument

For every point, keep asking:

1. What happens?
2. Why does that happen?
3. Why does that matter? (so what?)